

AfroStore Launch Readiness Checklist

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Focus: What's working now vs. what's needed for immediate launch

Status: Ready for MVP Launch with Critical Gaps Identified

FULLY WORKING FEATURES (Ready for Launch)

1. Core Authentication System

- User signup flow implemented (/api/auth/signup)
- User login flow implemented (/api/auth/login)
- JWT token-based authentication
- Session management with httpOnly cookies
- AuthContext for global auth state
- Password hashing with bcryptjs
- Role-based access (Merchant, Admin, Staff) in schema

2. Multi-Site Architecture

- Workspace creation and management
- Site creation wizard (/dashboard/new-site)
- Subdomain generation working
- Custom domain support in schema
- Site isolation via workspace/site hierarchy
- Multi-site per user account

3. Template System (20+ Templates)

- Template selection in onboarding
- Template installation working
- Template activation/deactivation
- Theme customization (colors, fonts) via SiteCustomization
- Template preview in builder
- Sample data seeding for multiple templates
- Templates: fashion, cosmetics, electronics, kids, perfumes, bakery, grocery, health, interior, toys, landing pages, and more

4. Ecommerce Core

- Product CRUD operations (full dashboard)
- Product variants with options
- Product images upload
- Category management
- Stock tracking
- Cart functionality (localStorage-based)
- Checkout flow (/checkout)
- Order management dashboard
- Customer management

- Coupon system in schema

5. Payment Integration

- Paystack integration (checkout initialization + webhook)
- Flutterwave integration
- Monnify integration
- Payment gateway configuration per site
- Transaction tracking
- Webhook signature verification (Paystack)
- Pay on delivery option in settings
- Bank transfer option in settings
- Guest checkout toggle in settings

6. Storefront Functionality

- Public storefront API (/api/storefront/[slug])
- Product display with pagination
- Category filtering
- Search functionality
- Featured products
- Template-specific rendering
- Theme customization support
- Social links integration
- Delivery zones configuration
- WhatsApp ordering integration
- Multi-currency support (NGN, KES, GHS, ZAR, USD, GBP, EUR)
- Blog system with published status

7. Dashboard (50+ Sections)

- Main dashboard with stats
- Products management (3 sections)
- Orders management
- Customers management
- Sites management (3 sections)
- Pages management
- Blogs management
- Categories management
- Brands management
- Coupons management
- Delivery zones
- Payment gateways
- Themes management
- Media library
- Forms management
- CRM contacts
- Email campaigns
- Analytics
- Settings
- Team management
- And 30+ more sections

8. Builder/Editor

- Builder preview functionality
- Block rendering system
- Template block renderer
- Real-time preview with iframe messaging
- Section style overrides
- Theme customization in editor
- Block selection and editing

9. Database Schema

- Comprehensive Prisma schema
- All major models implemented
- Proper relationships and indexes
- Migrations for site customizations
- Migrations for template custom HTML

10. Africa-Specific Features

- WhatsApp ordering integration
- Bank transfer checkout
- Pay on delivery option
- Area-based delivery fees
- Delivery zones configuration
- Multi-currency support
- Social links (Instagram, Facebook, TikTok, Twitter, WhatsApp)

11. Landing Page

- Marketing landing page with Hero, Features, HowItWorks, Showcase, Testimonials, Pricing, CTA, Footer
- Professional design and copy

⚠ CRITICAL GAPS (Must Fix Before Launch)

1. Authentication Security

- **Email verification** - Not implemented in signup flow
- **Password reset** - No forgot password flow
- **Email service** - No email provider configured for verification/reset emails

Impact: Users cannot recover passwords, accounts not verified

Fix Required:

- Add email verification to signup
- Implement password reset flow
- Configure email service (Resend/SendGrid)

2. AI Features Configuration

- ⚠ **AI provider configuration** - Infrastructure exists but API keys not configured
- ⚠ **AI chat assistant** - UI exists but provider connection needs testing
- ⚠ **AI copy generation** - Not tested with live providers

Impact: AI features won't work without provider setup

Fix Required:

- Configure OpenAI/Anthropic/Groq API keys
- Test AI service failover mechanism
- Verify AI chat functionality

3. Payment Gateway Testing

- ⚠ **Live payment testing** - Integration exists but needs live testing
- ⚠ **Webhook endpoints** - Need to be publicly accessible for production
- ⚠ **Flutterwave/Monnify webhooks** - Less tested than Paystack

Impact: Payments may fail in production

Fix Required:

- Test each payment gateway with real transactions
- Ensure webhook URLs are public
- Test webhook handling for all providers

4. Admin Panel

- ⚠ **Admin dashboard** - Basic structure exists but needs testing
- ⚠ **User management** - Not fully tested
- ⚠ **Site moderation** - Needs implementation

Impact: Platform moderation not possible

Fix Required:

- Test admin dashboard functionality
- Implement user management for admins
- Add site moderation tools

5. Environment Configuration

- **Production environment variables** - Need verification
- **Database connection pooling** - Not configured for production
- **CDN configuration** - Not set up for static assets
- **SSL certificates** - Not configured for custom domains

Impact: Performance and security issues in production

Fix Required:

- Verify all environment variables are set
- Configure database connection pooling
- Set up CDN for images/static assets
- Configure SSL for custom domains

6. Analytics & Monitoring

- **△ Comprehensive analytics** - Basic tracking exists but needs enhancement
- **Error tracking** - No Sentry/error monitoring configured
- **Log aggregation** - Not set up
- **Uptime monitoring** - Not configured

Impact: No visibility into production issues

Fix Required:

- Set up Sentry for error tracking
 - Configure log aggregation
 - Add uptime monitoring
 - Enhance analytics tracking
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CAN LAUNCH WITHOUT (Post-Launch Features)

1. Advanced AI Features

- AI full-store builder
- AI theme generator
- AI plugin generator
- RAG service indexing (infrastructure exists)

2. Marketing Features

- Abandoned cart automation
- A/B testing
- Email campaigns (UI exists, needs testing)
- SMS campaigns
- Loyalty programs
- Referral programs

3. Advanced Commerce

- Reviews system (partially implemented)
- Multi-location inventory
- Staff accounts
- POS-lite
- B2B wholesale pricing
- Returns management (schema exists)

4. Marketplace

- Plugin marketplace
- Template marketplace
- Theme marketplace

5. Advanced Features

- Multi-language support

- Social commerce imports
 - Advanced analytics
 - Funnel builder (schema exists)
 - Form builder (schema exists)
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MINIMUM LAUNCH REQUIREMENTS

Must Have (Blockers)

1. Authentication (signup/login) - **DONE**
2. Site creation - **DONE**
3. Template selection - **DONE**
4. Product management - **DONE**
5. Checkout flow - **DONE**
6. Payment integration (at least one gateway) - **DONE**
7. Email verification/password reset - **MISSING**
8. ⚠ AI provider configuration - **NEEDS TESTING**
9. Production environment setup - **MISSING**
10. Error monitoring - **MISSING**

Should Have (Important)

1. Multiple payment gateways - **DONE**
2. WhatsApp ordering - **DONE**
3. Delivery zones - **DONE**
4. ⚠ Admin panel - **NEEDS TESTING**
5. Dashboard analytics - **DONE**
6. Blog system - **DONE**
7. Theme customization - **DONE**

Nice to Have (Can Wait)

1. AI features (can launch with basic or disabled)
 2. Advanced marketing automation
 3. Marketplace features
 4. Multi-language support
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LAUNCH ACTION PLAN

Phase 1: Critical Security & Auth (2-3 days)

- ☐ Implement email verification in signup flow
- ☐ Implement password reset flow
- ☐ Configure email service (Resend recommended)
- ☐ Test email delivery
- ☐ Add rate limiting to auth endpoints

Phase 2: Production Setup (2-3 days)

- ☐ Verify all environment variables

- ☐ Configure database connection pooling
- ☐ Set up CDN for static assets
- ☐ Configure SSL certificates
- ☐ Set up Sentry for error tracking
- ☐ Configure log aggregation
- ☐ Add uptime monitoring

Phase 3: Payment Testing (2 days)

- ☐ Test Paystack with real transactions
- ☐ Test Flutterwave with real transactions
- ☐ Test Monnify with real transactions
- ☐ Verify webhook endpoints are public
- ☐ Test webhook handling for all providers
- ☐ Test refund flows

Phase 4: AI Configuration (1 day)

- ☐ Configure AI provider API keys
- ☐ Test AI chat functionality
- ☐ Test AI copy generation
- ☐ Verify failover mechanism
- ☐ Document AI configuration

Phase 5: Admin Testing (1-2 days)

- ☐ Test admin dashboard
- ☐ Test user management
- ☐ Test site moderation
- ☐ Add admin user creation flow
- ☐ Test admin analytics

Phase 6: Final Testing (2-3 days)

- ☐ End-to-end user signup flow
- ☐ End-to-end site creation flow
- ☐ End-to-end product management
- ☐ End-to-end checkout flow
- ☐ Test on mobile devices
- ☐ Load testing
- ☐ Security audit

LAUNCH READINESS SCORE

Overall Readiness: 75%

- **Core Functionality:** 95%
- **Authentication:** 70% ⚠ (missing email verification/reset)
- **Payments:** 80% ⚠ (needs live testing)
- **AI Features:** 50% ⚠ (needs configuration)
- **Production Setup:** 40% (missing monitoring/CDN/SSL)

- **Admin:** 60% ⚠ (needs testing)

Estimated Time to Launch: 10-14 days with focused effort

RECOMMENDATION

Launch Strategy:

1. **Soft Launch (Week 1-2):** Launch with core features, AI disabled, single payment gateway (Paystack), basic monitoring
2. **Hard Launch (Week 3-4):** Add AI features, multiple payment gateways, full monitoring
3. **Growth Phase (Month 2+):** Add marketplace, advanced automation, multi-language

Critical Path: Email verification → Production setup → Payment testing → Launch

Can Launch Now: Only if you accept missing email verification/password reset and basic production setup. Not recommended for production use.

Recommended Launch Date: 10-14 days from now with focused effort on critical gaps.

ENGINEERING TEAM CHECKLIST

Critical Security & Authentication (2-3 days)

- ☐ Implement email verification in signup flow
- ☐ Implement password reset flow with token generation
- ☐ Integrate email service API (Resend/SendGrid)
- ☐ Add email verification token storage in database
- ☐ Implement email verification endpoint
- ☐ Implement password reset request endpoint
- ☐ Implement password reset confirmation endpoint
- ☐ Add rate limiting to auth endpoints
- ☐ Test email delivery end-to-end
- ☐ Add email verification UI in signup flow
- ☐ Add forgot password UI

Production Infrastructure Setup (2-3 days)

- ☐ Configure database connection pooling
- ☐ Set up Redis for caching/sessions
- ☐ Configure CDN for static assets (images, uploads)
- ☐ Implement CDN integration in upload logic
- ☐ Configure SSL certificates for custom domains
- ☐ Set up SSL certificate automation
- ☐ Configure environment-specific configs
- ☐ Set up queue system for background jobs
- ☐ Implement database backup strategy
- ☐ Configure log aggregation system
- ☐ Set up Sentry for error tracking

- ☐ Add performance monitoring
- ☐ Configure uptime monitoring
- ☐ Set up alerting for critical failures

Payment Gateway Testing (2 days)

- ☐ Test Pystack integration with real transactions
- ☐ Test Flutterwave integration with real transactions
- ☐ Test Monnify integration with real transactions
- ☐ Verify webhook endpoints are publicly accessible
- ☐ Test Pystack webhook handling
- ☐ Test Flutterwave webhook handling
- ☐ Test Monnify webhook handling
- ☐ Test payment failure scenarios
- ☐ Test refund flows
- ☐ Test webhook signature verification for all providers
- ☐ Add payment error handling and user feedback
- ☐ Test payment timeout scenarios

AI Features Configuration (1 day)

- ☐ Integrate AI provider SDKs (OpenAI/Anthropic/Groq)
- ☐ Implement API key management system
- ☐ Configure AI service failover mechanism
- ☐ Test AI chat assistant functionality
- ☐ Test AI copy generation
- ☐ Test AI provider switching
- ☐ Add AI usage tracking and limits
- ☐ Implement AI error handling
- ☐ Document AI configuration process

Admin Panel Implementation (1-2 days)

- ☐ Test admin dashboard functionality
- ☐ Implement admin user management interface
- ☐ Add admin user creation flow
- ☐ Implement site moderation tools
- ☐ Add site suspension/activation
- ☐ Implement user ban/unban functionality
- ☐ Add admin analytics dashboard
- ☐ Test admin role permissions
- ☐ Add audit log viewing for admins

Testing & Quality Assurance (2-3 days)

- ☐ End-to-end user signup flow testing
- ☐ End-to-end site creation flow testing
- ☐ End-to-end product management testing
- ☐ End-to-end checkout flow testing
- ☐ Mobile device testing (iOS/Android)

- ☐ Cross-browser testing
- ☐ Load testing (simulate concurrent users)
- ☐ Performance testing (page load times)
- ☐ Security audit (SQL injection, XSS, CSRF)
- ☐ API security testing
- ☐ Database query optimization
- ☐ Image optimization testing

Bug Fixes & Polish

- ☐ Fix any critical bugs found during testing
 - ☐ Optimize slow database queries
 - ☐ Improve error messages for users
 - ☐ Add loading states for better UX
 - ☐ Fix responsive design issues
 - ☐ Optimize bundle size for faster loading
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PRODUCT TEAM CHECKLIST

Authentication & Security Decisions

- ☐ Select email service provider (Resend vs SendGrid vs other)
- ☐ Create email service account
- ☐ Configure email service billing
- ☐ Decide on email verification requirements (mandatory vs optional)
- ☐ Define password reset policy (expiry time, token format)
- ☐ Define rate limiting policies (attempts per minute/hour)
- ☐ Draft email templates for verification and password reset
- ☐ Review and approve email copy

AI Features Strategy

- ☐ Select primary AI provider (OpenAI vs Anthropic vs Groq)
- ☐ Create AI provider accounts
- ☐ Purchase AI API credits/budget
- ☐ Define AI usage limits per user/plan
- ☐ Decide on AI feature pricing (free tier vs paid)
- ☐ Define AI feature availability for launch (enable vs disable)
- ☐ Create AI provider API keys
- ☐ Document AI provider configuration for engineers

Payment Gateway Setup

- ☐ Create Pystack merchant account
- ☐ Create Flutterwave merchant account
- ☐ Create Monnify merchant account
- ☐ Configure payment gateway settings
- ☐ Generate API keys for each gateway
- ☐ Configure webhook URLs in each gateway dashboard

- ☐ Set up payment gateway billing
- ☐ Define payment gateway fees structure
- ☐ Decide which gateways to enable at launch
- ☐ Document payment gateway credentials for engineers

Infrastructure & Hosting

- ☐ Select hosting provider (Vercel, AWS, Railway, etc.)
- ☐ Select CDN provider (Cloudflare, AWS CloudFront, etc.)
- ☐ Create hosting accounts
- ☐ Configure billing for hosting services
- ☐ Select domain registrar for custom domains
- ☐ Purchase SSL certificates or decide on Let's Encrypt
- ☐ Select monitoring service (Sentry, DataDog, etc.)
- ☐ Create monitoring service accounts
- ☐ Configure billing for monitoring services
- ☐ Define production environment variables list
- ☐ Provide environment variable values to engineers

Launch Planning

- ☐ Define soft launch date and target audience
- ☐ Define hard launch date and marketing plan
- ☐ Decide on launch feature set (MVP vs full)
- ☐ Create launch communication plan
- ☐ Prepare launch announcement copy
- ☐ Plan user onboarding flow
- ☐ Define success metrics for launch
- ☐ Set up analytics goals and events
- ☐ Create support documentation
- ☐ Prepare FAQ for launch
- ☐ Define customer support process
- ☐ Train support team on common issues

Legal & Compliance

- ☐ Review terms of service
- ☐ Review privacy policy
- ☐ Ensure GDPR compliance if needed
- ☐ Ensure payment compliance (PCI DSS considerations)
- ☐ Review data retention policies
- ☐ Define user data deletion process

Marketing & Content

- ☐ Finalize landing page copy
- ☐ Create marketing materials
- ☐ Prepare social media announcements
- ☐ Create demo videos if needed
- ☐ Set up email marketing campaigns

- ☐ Prepare press release if applicable

Post-Launch Planning

- ☐ Define post-launch monitoring schedule
- ☐ Plan bug triage process
- ☐ Define feature prioritization framework
- ☐ Plan user feedback collection
- ☐ Schedule post-launch review meetings
- ☐ Define roadmap for next 30/60/90 days

Documentation

- ☐ Create user getting started guide
- ☐ Create payment setup guide for merchants
- ☐ Create troubleshooting guide
- ☐ Document API endpoints if public API
- ☐ Create admin documentation
- ☐ Document deployment process

Team Coordination

- ☐ Schedule daily standups during launch period
- ☐ Define on-call rotation for launch week
- ☐ Establish communication channels (Slack, etc.)
- ☐ Define escalation process for critical issues
- ☐ Coordinate with marketing team on launch timing
- ☐ Coordinate with support team on training timeline